John 13 - 15

Key Notes, Cross-References, and Prophecy Fulfilled (WEB)

The night before the Passover. One room. One last supper.

And John opens it with a sentence that holds the rest of the book. Having loved His own who were in the world, He loved them to the end.

Then the One who knew the Father had given all things into His hands gets up from the table, takes off His outer clothes, wraps a towel around His waist, and kneels down with a basin.

He washes their feet. Every one of them. Including the man who has already decided to betray Him.

Peter refuses. You will never wash my feet. And then, when he understands, he asks for a bath.

Then a piece of bread dipped and handed across the table, and Judas walks out into the dark.

And it was night.

Then a new commandment. Love one another. Not the way you love yourself. The way I loved you.

Then Peter promising to die for Him, and being told the rooster will not crow before he has denied Him three times.

And then, to eleven frightened men, the most tender words He ever spoke.

Let not your heart be troubled.

In My Father's house are many dwelling places. I am going to prepare a place for you. I will come again.

I am the way, the truth, and the life.

He who has seen Me has seen the Father.

If you love Me, keep My commandments - and I will ask the Father, and He will give you another Counselor, to be with you forever.

I will not leave you orphans.

Peace I leave with you. Not as the world gives.

Then, somewhere between the room and the garden: I am the true vine, and you are the branches.

Remain in Me. Apart from Me you can do nothing.

Greater love has no one than this, that someone lay down his life for his friends.

I do not call you servants anymore. I have called you friends.

You did not choose Me. I chose you.

This is not just history.

This is a mirror.

And tonight, we let the Word fill us.

CHAPTER 13 - A Towel and a Basin, a Morsel Handed to a Traitor, and a New Commandment

Key Notes

- “Before the feast of the Passover” is John’s own time stamp on this meal. The next morning the leaders will not enter the governor’s house so that they can still eat the Passover, and the day of the crucifixion is called the preparation of the Passover. In John, this supper comes before the Passover meal (John 13:1, 18:28, 19:14).
- “He loved them to the end” can also mean to the uttermost, completely. The word is from the same root as His last word on the cross: it is finished (John 13:1, 19:30).
- Judas had already been given the thought by the devil before the washing began. Yahshua washed his feet knowing it (John 13:2, 13:11).
- “Knowing that the Father had given all things into his hands” - and what He did with all things in His hands was pick up a towel. Power, in this Gospel, kneels (John 13:3-4).
- “Laid aside his outer garments” uses the same verb He used for laying down His life in chapter 10, and “put his outer garment back on” uses the same verb as taking it up again. The foot washing is the cross acted out in a room (John 13:4, 13:12, 10:17-18).
- Washing feet was so low a task that it was given to the lowest servant in a house. Abigail offered to wash the feet of David’s servants as the humblest thing she could say (John 13:5, 1 Samuel 25:41).
- “You will never wash my feet!” Peter’s refusal sounds humble and is actually pride. He wants to be the one who serves, not the one who needs it (John 13:8).
- “If I don’t wash you, you have no part with me.” Being served by Him is not optional. Everyone who belongs to Him has to let Him kneel (John 13:8).
- “Someone who has bathed only needs to have his feet washed.” A guest bathed at home and only his feet got dirty on the road. Cleansing once, and then daily washing of what the walk picks up (John 13:10, Exodus 30:19-21).
- “You ought also to wash one another’s feet.” Some assemblies practice it literally; all are commanded the thing it means (John 13:14-15).
- “A servant is not greater than his lord.” Said here about serving, and repeated two chapters later about suffering (John 13:16, 15:20).
- “He who eats bread with me has lifted up his heel against me” is Psalm 41, David on a trusted friend who turned. To lift the heel is to kick, or to show contempt (John 13:18, Psalm 41:9).
- “That you may believe that I am he” is ego eimi again, and again in the words of Isaiah: I declare the end from the beginning. He tells them beforehand so that the betrayal will confirm Him rather than shake them (John 13:19, Isaiah 46:10).

- “He was troubled in spirit” - the same word used at Lazarus’s tomb and in 12:27. Betrayal by a friend hurt Him (John 13:21, 11:33, 12:27).
- They reclined at table, on their left sides, heads toward the table. The disciple whom Jesus loved was next to Him, at His breast - the same word used of the Son in the bosom of the Father (John 13:23, 1:18).
- “The disciple whom Jesus loved” first appears here and is never named. The traditional answer is John the son of Zebedee, the author. He calls himself by the one thing he was sure of (John 13:23, 21:20-24).
- To dip a piece of bread and hand it to someone was a mark of honor from the host. Boaz did it for Ruth. The last thing Yahshua offered Judas was friendship (John 13:26, Ruth 2:14).
- “After the piece of bread, then Satan entered into him.” He took the honor and left with the enemy (John 13:27).
- “What you do, do quickly.” No one at the table understood it. Some thought He was sending Judas to give something to the poor (John 13:27-29).
- “He went out immediately. It was night.” Four words in Greek. He walked away from the light of the world into the dark (John 13:30, 8:12).
- “Now the Son of Man has been glorified.” The moment the betrayer leaves, Yahshua calls it glory. The cross has begun (John 13:31).
- “Little children” is the only time He calls them that in the Gospels. John picked it up and used it all through his letters (John 13:33, 1 John 2:1).
- Love your neighbor as yourself was not new. It is in Leviticus 19. What is new is the measure: just as I have loved you. The standard moved from self to Him (John 13:34, Leviticus 19:18).
- “By this everyone will know that you are my disciples.” Not by doctrine, not by dress, not by argument - though all have their place. By love for one another (John 13:35).
- “I will lay down my life for you.” Peter means it, and he will draw a sword in the garden to prove it. Pride goes before a fall, and the fall is a few hours away (John 13:37, 18:10, Proverbs 16:18).
- “The rooster won’t crow until you have denied me three times.” He predicts the failure, and in chapter 21 He will restore it three times over (John 13:38, 21:15-17).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
The Fourteenth Day at Evening	John 13:1 • Exodus 12:6 • Leviticus 23:5
A Servant to Wash Feet	John 13:5 • 1 Samuel 25:41 • Genesis 18:4
Washed and Clean	John 13:10 • Exodus 30:19-21 • Ezekiel 36:25
Not Above His Lord	John 13:16 • Matthew 10:24
Bread Dipped and Given	John 13:26 • Ruth 2:14

Topic	References
Love Your Neighbor as Yourself	John 13:34 • Leviticus 19:18 • Leviticus 19:34
Pride Before a Fall	John 13:37 • Proverbs 16:18 • Psalm 30:6-7

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
Loved With an Everlasting Love	John 13:1 • Jeremiah 31:3 • Hosea 11:4
My Servant	John 13:4 • Isaiah 42:1 • Isaiah 49:3
He Lifted Up His Heel	John 13:18 • Psalm 41:9 • Psalm 55:12-14
Declaring the End From the Beginning	John 13:19 • Isaiah 46:9-10 • Isaiah 43:10
The Son of Man Glorified	John 13:31 • Daniel 7:14 • Isaiah 49:3
The Law Written on the Heart	John 13:34 • Jeremiah 31:33 • Ezekiel 36:26-27

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 13 Commentary (David Guzik) - the foot washing, the betrayer revealed, and the new commandment
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 13A - exposition of the upper room and the washing of the disciples' feet

John 13 - Opening Intro

This is the night before the Passover. John is careful to tell us that. Before the feast.

And he opens it with one of the most beautiful sentences in the Bible. Having loved His own who were in the world, He loved them to the end.

To the end. Or, you could translate it, to the uttermost. All the way. And it is the same root as the last thing He will say on the cross. It is finished.

Then John tells us what Yahshua knew. He knew the Father had put all things into His hands. He knew He came from God and was going back to God.

And with all things in His hands, what does He do? He gets up from supper. He takes off His outer clothes. He wraps a towel around His waist. He pours water in a basin. And He gets down on the floor and starts washing feet.

That was the job you gave to the lowest servant in the house. And the One who holds all things is on His knees with a towel.

And here is something you might miss. The word for laying aside His clothes is the same word He used in chapter 10 for laying down His life. And when He finishes and puts His clothes back on, it is the same word as taking His life back up. John is showing you the cross, acted out in a room, before it happens.

And He comes to Peter. And Peter says: Lord, You are going to wash my feet? You will never wash my feet.

Now that sounds humble, does it not? It is not. It is pride. Peter wants to be the one who serves, not the one who needs serving.

And Yahshua says: if I do not wash you, you have no part with Me.

You do not get to belong to Him without letting Him kneel in front of you.

And Peter swings all the way the other way. Then wash my hands and my head too!

And Yahshua says: someone who has had a bath only needs his feet washed. You walked here clean, but your feet got dirty on the road. Cleansed once - and then washed of what the walk picks up.

And then He says the hardest thing: you are clean, but not all of you. Because He knew who was going to betray Him. And He had just washed that man's feet too.

He sits back down. Do you understand what I just did? You call Me Teacher and Lord, and you are right. If I, your Lord and Teacher, washed your feet, you ought to wash one another's feet.

Then He gets troubled in spirit, and says it out loud. One of you will betray Me.

They look at each other. And Peter signals to the disciple Jesus loved - the one leaning against His chest - ask Him who.

And Yahshua says: it is the one I give this piece of bread to after I dip it. And He dips it and hands it to Judas.

Now hear this. To dip a piece of bread and hand it to someone at the table was an honor. The host did that for a guest he wanted to bless. Boaz did it for Ruth. The very last thing Yahshua offered Judas was friendship.

And after Judas took it, Satan entered into him.

And Yahshua says: what you are going to do, do it quickly. And nobody at the table understands. They think Judas is going to buy something for the feast or give something to the poor.

And Judas gets up and walks out. And John writes four words. And it was night.

He walked away from the Light of the world into the dark.

And the moment the door shuts behind him, Yahshua says: now the Son of Man is glorified.

And then He turns to the eleven and calls them something He never called them before. Little children. I am only with you a little longer.

And He gives them a new commandment. Love one another. Just as I have loved you, love one another.

Now love your neighbor was not new. That is Leviticus 19. What is new is the measure. Not as you love yourself. As I loved you. And He just finished showing them what that looks like - on His knees, with a towel, washing the feet of the man who was about to sell Him.

By this everyone will know you are My disciples. If you love one another.

And Peter says: Lord, where are You going? Why can I not follow You now? I will lay down my life for You.

And he means it. He really does. And Yahshua says: will you lay down your life for Me? Most certainly I tell you, the rooster will not crow until you have denied Me three times.

Before we read - look at who was at that table. A traitor whose feet He washed. A loud disciple who would deny Him by morning. And He loved them to the end. All of them.

John 13:1-38 (WEB)

1 Now before the feast of the Passover, Jesus, knowing that his time had come that he would depart from this world to the Father, having loved his own who were in the world, he loved them to the end.[1]

2 During supper, the devil having already put into the heart of Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, to betray him,

3 Jesus, knowing that the Father had given all things into his hands, and that he came from God, and was going to God,

4 arose from supper, and laid aside his outer garments. He took a towel, and wrapped a towel around his waist.[2]

5 Then he poured water into the basin, and began to wash the disciples' feet, and to wipe them with the towel that was wrapped around him.[3]

6 Then he came to Simon Peter. He said to him, "Lord, do you wash my feet?"

7 Jesus answered him, "You don't know what I am doing now, but you will understand later."

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[1] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 12:6 • Leviticus 23:5 - *the lamb kept until the fourteenth day and killed at evening, Yahweh's Passover*

[2] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 42:1 • Isaiah 49:3 - *behold my servant whom I uphold, my chosen, and you are my servant, in whom I will be glorified*

[3] **Cross-Reference:** 1 Samuel 25:41 • Genesis 18:4 - *Abigail's servant to wash the feet of the servants, and Abraham fetching water for his guests' feet*

8 Peter said to him, “You will never wash my feet!” Jesus answered him, “If I don’t wash you, you have no part with me.”

9 Simon Peter said to him, “Lord, not my feet only, but also my hands and my head!”

10 Jesus said to him, “Someone who has bathed only needs to have his feet washed, but is completely clean. You are clean, but not all of you.”[4]

11 For he knew him who would betray him, therefore he said, “You are not all clean.”

12 So when he had washed their feet, put his outer garment back on, and sat down again, he said to them, “Do you know what I have done to you?

13 You call me, ‘Teacher’ and ‘Lord.’ You say so correctly, for so I am.

14 If I then, the Lord and the Teacher, have washed your feet, you also ought to wash one another’s feet.

15 For I have given you an example, that you also should do as I have done to you.

16 Most certainly I tell you, a servant is not greater than his lord, neither one who is sent greater than he who sent him.[5]

17 If you know these things, blessed are you if you do them.

18 I don’t speak concerning all of you. I know whom I have chosen. But that the Scripture may be fulfilled, ‘He who eats bread with me has lifted up his heel against me.’[6]

19 From now on, I tell you before it happens, that when it happens, you may believe that I am he.[7]

20 Most certainly I tell you, he who receives whomever I send, receives me; and he who receives me, receives him who sent me.”

21 When Jesus had said this, he was troubled in spirit, and testified, “Most certainly I tell you that one of you will betray me.”

22 The disciples looked at one another, perplexed about whom he spoke.

23 One of his disciples, whom Jesus loved, was at the table, leaning against Jesus’ breast.

24 Simon Peter therefore beckoned to him, and said to him, “Tell us who it is of whom he speaks.”

25 He, leaning back, as he was, on Jesus’ breast, asked him, “Lord, who is it?”

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[4] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 30:19-21 • Ezekiel 36:25 - *the priests washing hands and feet before they came near, and clean water sprinkled so you will be clean*

[5] **Cross-Reference:** Matthew 10:24 - *a disciple is not above his teacher, nor a servant above his lord*

[6] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 41:9 • Psalm 55:12-14 - *my familiar friend who ate bread with me has lifted up his heel against me, my companion with whom I took sweet fellowship*

[7] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 46:9-10 • Isaiah 43:10 - *I declare the end from the beginning, and that you may know and believe me and understand that I am he*

26 Jesus therefore answered, “It is he to whom I will give this piece of bread when I have dipped it.” So when he had dipped the piece of bread, he gave it to Judas, the son of Simon Iscariot.[8]

27 After the piece of bread, then Satan entered into him. Then Jesus said to him, “What you do, do quickly.”

28 Now no man at the table knew why he said this to him.

29 For some thought, because Judas had the money box, that Jesus said to him, “Buy what things we need for the feast,” or that he should give something to the poor.

30 Therefore having received that morsel, he went out immediately. It was night.

31 When he had gone out, Jesus said, “Now the Son of Man has been glorified, and God has been glorified in him.[9]

32 If God has been glorified in him, God will also glorify him in himself, and he will glorify him immediately.

33 Little children, I will be with you a little while longer. You will seek me, and as I said to the Jews, ‘Where I am going, you can’t come,’ so now I tell you.

34 A new commandment I give to you, that you love one another. Just as I have loved you, you also love one another.[10,11]

35 By this everyone will know that you are my disciples, if you have love for one another.”

36 Simon Peter said to him, “Lord, where are you going?” Jesus answered, “Where I am going, you can’t follow now, but you will follow afterwards.”

37 Peter said to him, “Lord, why can’t I follow you now? I will lay down my life for you.”[12]

38 Jesus answered him, “Will you lay down your life for me? Most certainly I tell you, the rooster won’t crow until you have denied me three times.

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[8] **Cross-Reference:** Ruth 2:14 - *Boaz inviting Ruth to dip her morsel and passing her grain at the meal*

[9] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Daniel 7:14 • Isaiah 49:3 - *glory and a kingdom given to the son of man, and my servant in whom I will be glorified*

[10] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Jeremiah 31:33 • Ezekiel 36:26-27 - *my law written in their heart, and a new heart and my Spirit within you to walk in my statutes*

[11] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 19:18 - *love your neighbor as yourself, I am Yahweh*

[12] **Cross-Reference:** Proverbs 16:18 • Psalm 30:6-7 - *pride goes before destruction, and I said in my prosperity, I shall never be moved*

CHAPTER 14 - Let Not Your Heart Be Troubled, the Way to the Father, and Another Counselor

Key Notes

- There is no chapter break in the conversation. Peter has just been told he will deny Him, and the next words are let not your heart be troubled. The comfort is spoken to a man about to fail (John 14:1, 13:38).
- “You believe in God. Believe also in me.” The Greek can be read as statements or commands. Either way He puts faith in Himself on the same level as faith in God (John 14:1).
- “In my Father’s house are many homes.” The word for homes is related to the verb remain, which runs through these chapters. Dwelling places, places to stay. It reappears in verse 23 for the home the Father and Son make with the believer (John 14:2, 14:23).
- “My Father’s house” was the temple in chapter 2. Here it is bigger than any building. And Revelation ends with God’s dwelling coming down to be with people, the holy city prepared like a bride (John 14:2, 2:16, Revelation 21:2-3).
- Many readers hear a wedding in these verses: a bridegroom going ahead to prepare a place and coming back for his bride. The details often attached to it come from later sources, but the picture fits a Gospel that has already called Him the bridegroom (John 14:2-3, 3:29).
- “I will come again, and will receive you to myself; that where I am, you may be there also.” The promise is not first a place. It is a Person. Where I am (John 14:3).
- “How can we know the way?” Thomas asks the honest question everyone else was too embarrassed to ask, and gets the answer the whole world quotes (John 14:5).
- “I am the way, the truth, and the life” is the sixth of the seven I AM sayings with a picture. The earliest believers were called simply the Way (John 14:6, Acts 9:2).
- “No one comes to the Father, except through me” is not a door slammed. It is a door opened, in the only place a door could be (John 14:6, 10:9).
- “Lord, show us the Father, and that will be enough for us.” Moses asked: show me your glory, and was told no man may see my face and live (John 14:8, Exodus 33:18-20).
- “He who has seen me has seen the Father.” Philip had been looking at the answer to Moses’s prayer for three years (John 14:9).
- “I am in the Father, and the Father in me.” Not two who agree. One who dwells in the other (John 14:10-11, 10:38).
- “Greater works than these he will do” - greater in reach, not in kind. A few thousand heard Him in Galilee; the Way went to the ends of the earth (John 14:12).
- “If you will ask anything in my name, I will do it.” In His name means as His representative, on His business, the way an agent signs for the one who sent him (John 14:13-14).

- “If you love me, keep my commandments” is the language of the ten commandments themselves: loving kindness to thousands of those who love me and keep my commandments. Love and obedience were never opposites (John 14:15, Exodus 20:6, Deuteronomy 7:9).
- “Another Counselor” - parakletos, one called alongside, an advocate, a helper. And another means another of the same kind. The Spirit will be to them what He has been (John 14:16).
- “He lives with you, and will be in you.” Ezekiel promised it: I will put my Spirit within you, and cause you to walk in my statutes (John 14:17, Ezekiel 36:27).
- “I will not leave you orphans.” A teacher’s disciples were sometimes called his children, and a rabbi’s death left them orphaned. He promises they will not be (John 14:18).
- “Because I live, you will live also.” His resurrection is the guarantee of theirs (John 14:19).
- “He who has my commandments, and keeps them, that person is one who loves me.” Said twice in seven verses, in case they missed it (John 14:15, 14:21).
- Judas - not Iscariot - asks the only question this disciple asks in the Gospels: why show yourself to us and not to the world? (John 14:22).
- “We will come to him, and make our home with him.” I will set my tent among you, and walk among you, Yahweh said in Leviticus. The Father and the Son move in (John 14:23, Leviticus 26:11-12).
- “He will teach you all things, and will remind you of all that I said to you.” This is how the Gospel John is writing came to be remembered (John 14:26).
- “Peace I leave with you. My peace I give to you.” Shalom was the ordinary goodbye. He gives it as an inheritance. Not as the world gives - the world gives peace by taking away the trouble; He gives it in the middle of it (John 14:27).
- “The Father is greater than I” is said by the Son who has taken the form of a servant, going to the cross. It is the same Son who said I and the Father are one (John 14:28, 10:30).
- “The prince of the world comes, and he has nothing in me.” No foothold, no claim, nothing to hold onto (John 14:30).
- “Arise, let us go from here.” And then three more chapters of teaching. Many think they left the room here and the rest was spoken on the way to the garden (John 14:31, 18:1).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Why Are You in Despair?	John 14:1 • Psalm 42:11 • Isaiah 26:3
The House of Yahweh Forever	John 14:2 • Psalm 23:6 • Revelation 21:2-3
The Holy Way	John 14:6 • Isaiah 35:8 • Jeremiah 6:16
Show Me Your Glory	John 14:8 • Exodus 33:18 • Exodus 33:20
Call to Me and I Will Answer	John 14:13 • Jeremiah 33:3 • Psalm 145:18

Topic	References
Those Who Love Me and Keep My Commandments	John 14:15 • Exodus 20:6 • Deuteronomy 7:9
I Will Set My Tent Among You	John 14:23 • Leviticus 26:11-12 • Ezekiel 37:27
Yahweh Give You Peace	John 14:27 • Numbers 6:26 • Isaiah 26:12

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
He Will Come Again	John 14:3 • Zechariah 14:4-5 • Daniel 7:13
The God of Truth	John 14:6 • Psalm 86:11 • Isaiah 65:16
Behold, Your God	John 14:9 • Isaiah 40:9 • Isaiah 9:6
My Spirit Within You	John 14:17 • Ezekiel 36:27 • Joel 2:28
A Father of the Fatherless	John 14:18 • Psalm 68:5 • Psalm 27:10
They Shall All Know Me	John 14:26 • Jeremiah 31:34 • Isaiah 11:2
He Will Be Our Peace	John 14:27 • Micah 5:5 • Isaiah 9:6

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 14 Commentary (David Guzik) - the Father's house, the way, the truth and the life, and the promise of the Counselor
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 14A - exposition of the upper room discourse and the promise of the Spirit

John 14 - Opening Intro

Peter has just been told he is going to deny Yahshua three times before morning. That is where chapter 13 ended.

And the very next words out of Yahshua's mouth are: let not your heart be troubled.

Hear that. He says it to a man who is about to fail Him. The comfort comes before the failure, not after it.

You believe in God. Believe also in Me.

And then: in My Father's house are many dwelling places. If it were not so, I would have told you. I am going to prepare a place for you.

My Father's house. Back in chapter 2, that was the temple - He made a whip and cleared it out. Here it is bigger than any building. And the book of Revelation ends with the holy city coming down from heaven, prepared like a bride, and a voice saying: God's dwelling is with people.

And then: I will come again and receive you to Myself, so that where I am, you will be also.

Notice what the promise is. It is not first a place. It is a Person. Where I am.

And Thomas - bless him - asks the question everybody else was thinking. Lord, we do not know where You are going. How can we know the way?

And Yahshua says the words the whole world knows. I am the way, the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father except through Me.

Some people hear that as a door slammed shut. It is the opposite. It is a door thrown open, in the one place a door could ever be.

And then Philip. Lord, show us the Father, and that will be enough.

Now think about what Philip just asked. That is what Moses asked on the mountain. Show me Your glory. And God said: you cannot see My face and live.

And Yahshua looks at Philip and says: have I been with you this long, and you still do not know Me? He who has seen Me has seen the Father.

Philip had been looking at the answer to Moses's prayer for three years.

And then He says the thing I want every one of us to hear tonight. If you love Me, keep My commandments.

Now where have we heard that before? The ten commandments. Exodus 20. Showing loving kindness to thousands of those who love Me and keep My commandments. Deuteronomy 7. The faithful God who keeps covenant with those who love Him and keep His commandments.

Love and obedience were never enemies. They were always the same thing seen from two sides.

And right after that, a promise. I will ask the Father, and He will give you another Counselor, to be with you forever. The Spirit of truth. He lives with you now - and He will be in you.

Another Counselor. The word is parakletos - someone called to your side. An advocate. A helper. And another means another of the same kind. What Yahshua has been to them, the Spirit will be.

That is Ezekiel 36. I will put My Spirit within you and cause you to walk in My statutes. Notice what the Spirit does - He causes you to walk in the instructions. The Spirit and the commandments are not on opposite teams.

I will not leave you orphans. I will come to you.

And then: if a man loves Me, he will keep My word, and My Father will love him, and We will come to him and make Our home with him.

Our home. That is the same word as the dwelling places in verse 2. He is going to prepare a place for you - and in the meantime, the Father and the Son are moving into you.

And then the inheritance. Peace I leave with you. My peace I give to you. Not as the world gives.

The world gives peace by taking the trouble away. He gives peace right in the middle of it. Do not let your heart be troubled, and do not let it be afraid.

And He ends with: arise, let us go from here.

Before we read - notice that every promise in this chapter is spoken to frightened men on the worst night of their lives. If He could say let not your heart be troubled to them, He can say it to you.

John 14:1-31 (WEB)

1 "Don't let your heart be troubled. Believe in God. Believe also in me.[13]

2 In my Father's house are many homes. If it weren't so, I would have told you. I am going to prepare a place for you.[14]

3 If I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again, and will receive you to myself; that where I am, you may be there also.[15]

4 Where I go, you know, and you know the way."

5 Thomas said to him, "Lord, we don't know where you are going. How can we know the way?"

6 Jesus said to him, "I am the way, the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father, except through me.[16]

7 If you had known me, you would have known my Father also. From now on, you know him, and have seen him."

8 Philip said to him, "Lord, show us the Father, and that will be enough for us."[17]

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[13] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 42:11 • Isaiah 26:3 - *why are you in despair, my soul, hope in God, and perfect peace for the mind that trusts in you*

[14] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 23:6 • Revelation 21:2-3 - *I will dwell in Yahweh's house forever, and the holy city coming down with God's dwelling among people*

[15] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 14:4-5 • Daniel 7:13 - *his feet standing on the Mount of Olives and Yahweh coming with all the holy ones, and one like a son of man coming with the clouds*

[16] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 86:11 • Isaiah 65:16 - *teach me your way and I will walk in your truth, and the God of truth*

[17] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 33:18 • Exodus 33:20 - *please show me your glory, and you cannot see my face, for man may not see me and live*

9 Jesus said to him, “Have I been with you such a long time, and do you not know me, Philip? He who has seen me has seen the Father. How do you say, ‘Show us the Father?’[18]

10 Don’t you believe that I am in the Father, and the Father in me? The words that I tell you, I speak not from myself; but the Father who lives in me does his works.

11 Believe me that I am in the Father, and the Father in me; or else believe me for the very works’ sake.

12 Most certainly I tell you, he who believes in me, the works that I do, he will do also; and he will do greater works than these, because I am going to my Father.

13 Whatever you will ask in my name, that will I do, that the Father may be glorified in the Son.[19]

14 If you will ask anything in my name, I will do it.

15 If you love me, keep my commandments.[20]

16 I will pray to the Father, and he will give you another Counselor, that he may be with you forever,—

17 the Spirit of truth, whom the world can’t receive; for it doesn’t see him, neither knows him. You know him, for he lives with you, and will be in you.[21]

18 I will not leave you orphans. I will come to you.[22]

19 Yet a little while, and the world will see me no more; but you will see me. Because I live, you will live also.

20 In that day you will know that I am in my Father, and you in me, and I in you.

21 One who has my commandments, and keeps them, that person is one who loves me. One who loves me will be loved by my Father, and I will love him, and will reveal myself to him.”

22 Judas (not Iscariot) said to him, “Lord, what has happened that you are about to reveal yourself to us, and not to the world?”

23 Jesus answered him, “If a man loves me, he will keep my word. My Father will love him, and we will come to him, and make our home with him.[23]

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[18] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 40:9 • Isaiah 9:6 - *say to the cities of Judah, behold, your God, and the son given whose name is Mighty God, Everlasting Father*

[19] **Cross-Reference:** Jeremiah 33:3 • Psalm 145:18 - *call to me and I will answer you, and Yahweh is near to all who call on him in truth*

[20] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 20:6 • Deuteronomy 7:9 - *loving kindness to thousands of those who love me and keep my commandments, and the faithful God who keeps covenant with them*

[21] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 36:27 • Joel 2:28 - *I will put my Spirit within you and cause you to walk in my statutes, and I will pour out my Spirit on all flesh*

[22] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 68:5 • Psalm 27:10 - *a father of the fatherless is God in his holy habitation, and when father and mother forsake me, Yahweh will take me up*

[23] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 26:11-12 • Ezekiel 37:27 - *I will set my tent among you and walk among you, and my tent will be with them*

24 He who doesn't love me doesn't keep my words. The word which you hear isn't mine, but the Father's who sent me.

25 I have said these things to you, while still living with you.

26 But the Counselor, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name, he will teach you all things, and will remind you of all that I said to you.[24]

27 Peace I leave with you. My peace I give to you; not as the world gives, give I to you. Don't let your heart be troubled, neither let it be fearful.[25,26]

28 You heard how I told you, 'I go away, and I come to you.' If you loved me, you would have rejoiced, because I said 'I am going to my Father;' for the Father is greater than I.

29 Now I have told you before it happens so that, when it happens, you may believe.

30 I will no more speak much with you, for the prince of the world comes, and he has nothing in me.

31 But that the world may know that I love the Father, and as the Father commanded me, even so I do. Arise, let us go from here.

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[24] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Jeremiah 31:34 • Isaiah 11:2 - *they shall all know me from the least to the greatest, and the Spirit of wisdom and understanding resting on him*

[25] **Cross-Reference:** Numbers 6:26 • Isaiah 26:12 - *Yahweh lift up his face toward you and give you peace, and Yahweh will ordain peace for us*

[26] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Micah 5:5 • Isaiah 9:6 - *he will be our peace, and his name will be called Prince of Peace*

CHAPTER 15 - The True Vine, Greater Love, and Hated Without a Cause

Key Notes

- Israel was Yahweh's vine. You brought a vine out of Egypt, the psalm says. Isaiah sang about a vineyard that produced wild grapes. Jeremiah called Israel a noble vine turned degenerate (John 15:1, Psalm 80:8, Isaiah 5:1-2, Jeremiah 2:21).
- "I am the true vine" is the last of the seven I AM sayings with a picture. Where Israel the vine failed to bear fruit, He is the vine that does. True means the real one that the others pointed to (John 15:1).
- A great golden vine decorated the entrance to the temple, according to the historian Josephus. If they passed the temple on the way to the garden, it was in front of them (John 15:1, 14:31).
- "My Father is the farmer." The vinedresser, the one who tends the vine. The whole operation is in the Father's hands (John 15:1).
- "Every branch in me that doesn't bear fruit, he takes away." The verb can also mean lifts up, as vinedressers lift trailing branches off the ground so they can bear. The WEB reads takes away (John 15:2).
- "Every branch that bears fruit, he prunes." Pruning is cutting, and it is done to the fruitful branches, not the dead ones. If you are being cut back, it may be because you are bearing (John 15:2, Isaiah 18:5).
- "You are already pruned clean because of the word which I have spoken to you." The same word in Greek serves for pruned and cleansed. The word He spoke was doing the cutting (John 15:3, 13:10).
- "Remain in me" - the word remain, or abide, appears about ten times in the first ten verses. It is the single instruction of the chapter (John 15:4-10).
- "Apart from me you can do nothing." Not less. Nothing (John 15:5).
- A branch that does not remain is thrown out and burned. Ezekiel asked what vine wood is good for, and answered: not even a peg to hang a pot on - it is fuel (John 15:6, Ezekiel 15:2-4).
- "If you remain in me, and my words remain in you, you will ask whatever you desire." His words remaining in us shape what we desire before we ask (John 15:7).
- "In this is my Father glorified, that you bear much fruit." Fruit, in Scripture, is what a life produces - character and works both. Isaiah promised Israel would fill the world with fruit (John 15:8, Isaiah 27:6).
- "If you keep my commandments, you will remain in my love; even as I have kept my Father's commandments." The Son Himself kept the Father's commandments, and He holds that up as the pattern (John 15:10).

- “That my joy may remain in you, and that your joy may be made full.” The whole chapter on pruning and remaining is aimed at joy (John 15:11, Psalm 16:11).
- “Greater love has no one than this, that someone lay down his life for his friends.” Said the night before He did exactly that (John 15:13).
- “You are my friends, if you do whatever I command you.” Friendship with Him is not casual. It shows in obedience (John 15:14).
- “No longer do I call you servants… but I have called you friends.” Abraham was called the friend of God. Yahweh spoke to Moses face to face, as a man speaks to his friend. That privilege now extends to eleven ordinary men (John 15:15, Isaiah 41:8, Exodus 33:11).
- A servant does not know what his master is doing. A friend is told. Everything He heard from the Father, He told them (John 15:15).
- “You didn’t choose me, but I chose you.” Disciples normally chose their rabbi. He reverses it. Yahweh chose Israel, not because they were many but because He loved them (John 15:16, Deuteronomy 7:6-7).
- “If the world hates you, you know that it has hated me before it hated you.” Rejection of His people is not new information. It is His own experience extended (John 15:18).
- “If they persecuted me, they will also persecute you.” The prophets were seized and stoned in the temple courts for speaking Yahweh’s word. The pattern is old (John 15:20, 2 Chronicles 24:21).
- “They hated me without a cause” is written in their law, He says - meaning the Psalms, where David says it twice. The word law here covers all of Scripture (John 15:25, Psalm 35:19, 69:4).
- “The Spirit of truth, who proceeds from the Father, will testify about me. You will also testify.” Two witnesses again - the Spirit and the disciples (John 15:26-27, Deuteronomy 19:15).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
The Vine Out of Egypt	John 15:1 • Psalm 80:8-9 • Isaiah 5:1-2
A Noble Vine Turned Degenerate	John 15:1 • Jeremiah 2:21 • Hosea 10:1
Pruning Hooks Before the Harvest	John 15:2 • Isaiah 18:5 • Malachi 3:3
Vine Wood for the Fire	John 15:6 • Ezekiel 15:2-4
Love Him and Keep His Commandments	John 15:10 • Deuteronomy 11:1 • Deuteronomy 7:9
The Friend of God	John 15:15 • Isaiah 41:8 • Exodus 33:11
Chosen Because He Loved You	John 15:16 • Deuteronomy 7:6-7 • Isaiah 41:9
The Prophets Persecuted	John 15:20 • 2 Chronicles 24:21 • Jeremiah 26:11

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
The Branch Your Right Hand Planted	John 15:1 • Psalm 80:14-15 • Isaiah 4:2
Israel Will Fill the World With Fruit	John 15:5 • Isaiah 27:6 • Hosea 14:7-8
Fullness of Joy	John 15:11 • Psalm 16:11 • Isaiah 61:10
He Poured Out His Soul to Death	John 15:13 • Isaiah 53:12 • Isaiah 53:4-5
Hated Without a Cause	John 15:25 • Psalm 35:19 • Psalm 69:4
My Spirit and My Words	John 15:26 • Isaiah 59:21 • Isaiah 48:16

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 15 Commentary (David Guzik) - the true vine, abiding, friendship with Yahshua, and the world's hatred
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 15A - exposition of the vine and the branches

John 15 - Opening Intro

They have just left the upper room - arise, let us go from here - and somewhere on the way to the garden, He says: I am the true vine, and My Father is the farmer.

And every one of those men knew what a vine meant. Israel was the vine. Psalm 80 - You brought a vine out of Egypt and planted it. Isaiah 5 - my beloved had a vineyard, and he looked for grapes, and it gave wild grapes. Jeremiah 2 - I planted you a noble vine, how did you turn into a degenerate one?

Israel was the vine that kept failing to bear fruit. And Yahshua says: I am the true vine. The one that actually does what the vine was supposed to do.

And then He talks about pruning. Every branch that does not bear fruit, He takes away. And every branch that does bear fruit, He prunes, so it will bear more.

Now hear that carefully. The pruning happens to the fruitful branches. Not the dead ones.

Some of you feel like you are being cut back right now. Things being taken away. And you have been reading it as punishment. It may be that you are being cut because you are bearing.

Then He says: you are already clean because of the word I have spoken to you. And the Greek word for clean is the same as the word for pruned. His word was doing the cutting.

And then one instruction, over and over. Remain in Me. Abide in Me. About ten times in ten verses.

As the branch cannot bear fruit by itself unless it stays on the vine, neither can you unless you remain in Me. I am the vine. You are the branches. Apart from Me you can do nothing.

Not less. Nothing.

And a branch that does not stay on the vine? It dries up and gets thrown in the fire. Ezekiel asked what vine wood is good for. You cannot build anything out of it. You cannot even make a peg to hang a pot on. It is only good for burning.

A branch is only good for one thing: being on the vine.

And then He ties it right back to obedience. If you keep My commandments, you will remain in My love - just as I have kept My Father's commandments and remain in His love.

He kept the Father's commandments. He is the pattern.

And then, why? These things I have spoken to you, that My joy may remain in you, and that your joy may be full.

All the pruning. All the abiding. All the commandments. The goal is joy.

And then: greater love has no one than this, that someone lay down his life for his friends.

And He said that the night before He did it.

And then something that should make every one of us stop. I do not call you servants anymore. A servant does not know what his master is doing. I have called you friends.

Friends. Abraham was called the friend of God. Moses talked with Yahweh face to face, like a man talks with his friend. And now eleven ordinary men - fishermen, a tax collector - are being called friends.

And then: you did not choose Me. I chose you.

In those days a student picked his rabbi. He flips it. He chose them. And Yahweh said that to Israel in Deuteronomy - I did not choose you because you were many. I chose you because I loved you.

And then He gets honest about what is coming. If the world hates you, remember it hated Me first. If they persecuted Me, they will persecute you.

And He quotes David. They hated Me without a cause.

Before we read - notice that a branch does not try hard to make grapes. It just stays connected. The fruit is what happens when the branch remains.

John 15:1-27 (WEB)

1 “I am the true vine, and my Father is the farmer.[27,28]

2 Every branch in me that doesn’t bear fruit, he takes away. Every branch that bears fruit, he prunes, that it may bear more fruit.[29]

3 You are already pruned clean because of the word which I have spoken to you.

4 Remain in me, and I in you. As the branch can’t bear fruit by itself, unless it remains in the vine, so neither can you, unless you remain in me.

5 I am the vine. You are the branches. He who remains in me, and I in him, the same bears much fruit, for apart from me you can do nothing.[30]

6 If a man doesn’t remain in me, he is thrown out as a branch, and is withered; and they gather them, throw them into the fire, and they are burned.[31]

7 If you remain in me, and my words remain in you, you will ask whatever you desire, and it will be done for you.

8 “In this is my Father glorified, that you bear much fruit; and so you will be my disciples.

9 Even as the Father has loved me, I also have loved you. Remain in my love.

10 If you keep my commandments, you will remain in my love; even as I have kept my Father’s commandments, and remain in his love.[32]

11 I have spoken these things to you, that my joy may remain in you, and that your joy may be made full.[33]

12 “This is my commandment, that you love one another, even as I have loved you.

13 Greater love has no one than this, that someone lay down his life for his friends.[34]

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[27] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 80:8-9 • Jeremiah 2:21 - *you brought a vine out of Egypt and planted it, and I planted you a noble vine, how then have you turned degenerate*

[28] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 80:14-15 • Isaiah 4:2 - *visit this vine, the branch you made strong for yourself, and Yahweh’s branch beautiful and glorious*

[29] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 18:5 • Malachi 3:3 - *the sprigs cut off with pruning hooks before the harvest, and the refiner purifying the sons of Levi*

[30] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 27:6 • Hosea 14:7-8 - *Israel blossoming and filling the world with fruit, and from me your fruit is found*

[31] **Cross-Reference:** Ezekiel 15:2-4 - *vine wood good for nothing but to be cast into the fire for fuel*

[32] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 11:1 • Deuteronomy 7:9 - *love Yahweh your God and keep his commandments always, and the faithful God who keeps covenant with those who love him*

[33] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 16:11 • Isaiah 61:10 - *in your presence is fullness of joy, and I will greatly rejoice in Yahweh*

[34] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:12 • Isaiah 53:4-5 - *he poured out his soul to death and bore the sin of many, and was pierced for our transgressions*

14 You are my friends, if you do whatever I command you.

15 No longer do I call you servants, for the servant doesn't know what his lord does. But I have called you friends, for everything that I heard from my Father, I have made known to you.[35]

16 You didn't choose me, but I chose you, and appointed you, that you should go and bear fruit, and that your fruit should remain; that whatever you will ask of the Father in my name, he may give it to you.[36]

17 "I command these things to you, that you may love one another.

18 If the world hates you, you know that it has hated me before it hated you.

19 If you were of the world, the world would love its own. But because you are not of the world, since I chose you out of the world, therefore the world hates you.

20 Remember the word that I said to you: 'A servant is not greater than his lord.' If they persecuted me, they will also persecute you. If they kept my word, they will also keep yours.[37]

21 But all these things will they do to you for my name's sake, because they don't know him who sent me.

22 If I had not come and spoken to them, they would not have had sin; but now they have no excuse for their sin.

23 He who hates me, hates my Father also.

24 If I hadn't done among them the works which no one else did, they wouldn't have had sin. But now have they seen and also hated both me and my Father.

25 But this happened so that the word may be fulfilled which was written in their law, 'They hated me without a cause.'[38]

26 "When the Counselor has come, whom I will send to you from the Father, the Spirit of truth, who proceeds from the Father, he will testify about me.[39]

27 You will also testify, because you have been with me from the beginning.

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[35] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 41:8 • Exodus 33:11 - *the offspring of Abraham my friend, and Yahweh speaking to Moses face to face as a man speaks to his friend*

[36] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 7:6-7 • Isaiah 41:9 - *chosen as his own possession, not because you were many, and I have chosen you and not cast you away*

[37] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Chronicles 24:21 • Jeremiah 26:11 - *Zechariah stoned in the court of Yahweh's house, and Jeremiah called worthy of death for his prophecy*

[38] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 35:19 • Psalm 69:4 - *those who hate me without a cause, more than the hairs of my head*

[39] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 59:21 • Isaiah 48:16 - *my Spirit who is on you and my words in your mouth, and the Lord Yahweh has sent me, with his Spirit*

Major Themes Across John 13-15

- A supper before the Passover, dated by John himself
- Loved to the end, in the language of it is finished
- All things in His hands, and what He did with them was pick up a towel
- Garments laid down and taken up, the cross acted out in a room
- Feet washed, including the feet of the man who would betray Him
- Pride dressed up as humility, refusing to be served
- Bathed once, and washed daily of what the road picks up
- A morsel of honor handed to a traitor
- He went out, and it was night
- Love your neighbor, now measured by as I have loved you
- Known by love for one another
- A failure foretold, and comfort spoken before it happened
- The Father's house, larger than any building, coming down to dwell with people
- A promise that is first a Person and then a place
- The way, the truth, and the life, the only door that could be opened
- The answer to Moses's prayer standing in front of Philip
- Love and obedience in the words of the ten commandments
- Another Counselor of the same kind, within and not only beside
- The Spirit who causes us to walk in His statutes
- No orphans, and a home made by the Father and the Son
- Peace in the middle of the trouble, not by its removal
- The true vine where Israel the vine had failed
- Pruning that falls on the fruitful branches
- Remain, said about ten times in ten verses
- Apart from Him, nothing
- Vine wood good only for the vine or the fire
- The Son who kept His Father's commandments
- Joy as the goal of all the cutting and remaining
- Greater love, spoken the night before He showed it
- Servants no longer, but friends, like Abraham and Moses
- Chosen by Him, not choosing Him
- Hated without a cause, and sent to testify anyway

Benediction

Let this be the word that goes before us tonight:

May we know we are loved to the end.

May we use whatever is in our hands to pick up a towel.

May we let Him wash us, and stop refusing what we need.

May we wash the feet of those who have hurt us.

May we walk in the light and never out into the night.

May we love one another as He has loved us.

May the world know us by our love.

May our hearts not be troubled, even on the night we fail.

May we long for where He is more than for the place.

May we walk the way, believe the truth, and live the life.

May we see the Father when we look at the Son.

May we love Him, and keep His commandments.

May the Counselor dwell in us and cause us to walk in His ways.

May we never live as orphans.

May the Father and the Son make their home in us.

May we receive His peace in the middle of the storm.

May we remain in the true vine.

May we welcome the pruning that makes us fruitful.

May His word make us clean.

May we never try to bear fruit apart from Him.

May our joy be full.

May we love to the point of laying down our lives.

May we live as His friends, and do what He commands.

May we remember that He chose us.

May we bear the world’s hatred as He bore it.

May we testify about Him by the Spirit of truth.

May every promise He has spoken over us stand up, come forth, and manifest in its appointed time.

Amen.